PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | SIEM/XDR, Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR & Detection Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Security Engineer with over five years of deep hands-on experience in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR, and detection engineering. I have built, deployed, and continuously improved detection capabilities protecting over 8,000 users, writing complex Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries and implementing detection-as-code principles to deliver scalable, high-fidelity alert logic. I work at the intersection of threat intelligence, MITRE ATT&CK framework coverage mapping, and security content development to ensure detection programmes stay ahead of evolving adversary techniques. With strong experience in Microsoft 365 E5 and Azure environments and a track record of integrating Sentinel and Defender XDR at enterprise scale, I bring both the technical depth and the communication skills to operate effectively in a hybrid UK-based role alongside engineering and security operations teams.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (analytics rule development, KQL, workbooks, incident management), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk/SPL
- **XDR / EDR:** Microsoft Defender XDR (M365 Defender), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **Detection Engineering:** Detection-as-code, alert logic design, KQL-based analytics rules, security content development, MITRE ATT&CK coverage mapping, false positive/negative tuning
- **SOAR & Automation:** Azure Logic Apps, Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, PowerShell scripting, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) automation
- **Incident Response & Threat Hunting:** NIST SP 800-61, hypothesis-driven hunting, threat intelligence integration, Digital Forensics and Incident Response (DFIR)
- **Identity & Access:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck
- **Cloud & Endpoint:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365, Tanium, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM)/Mobile Application Management (MAM), Check Point Harmony, Mimecast
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Lead detection engineering across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, writing and maintaining KQL-based analytics rules and detection content covering key MITRE ATT&CK tactics including initial access, credential access, lateral movement, and exfiltration.
- Apply detection-as-code principles to manage Sentinel analytics rules and XDR detection policies as version-controlled, testable content, improving consistency and enabling rapid deployment of new detection logic.
- Engineer Microsoft Defender XDR (M365 Defender) configurations including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), optimising alert logic and suppression rules to maximise signal quality across 8,000+ users.
- Conduct advanced KQL-based threat hunting in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying attacker activity that bypasses automated detections and feeding findings back into new detection rules.
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks using Azure Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment, threat intelligence lookups, and incident response actions to accelerate mean time to respond.

- Collaborate with IT and infrastructure teams to onboard new log sources into Sentinel, design data collection pipelines, and ensure log coverage aligns with detection priorities.
- Present security findings, detection programme updates, and incident post-mortems to technical and non-technical stakeholders, communicating risk and remediation clearly.
- Mentor junior security analysts in detection engineering techniques, KQL query development, and MITRE ATT&CK-based investigation methodologies.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Developed and tuned Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules using KQL, iteratively improving detection quality by analysing alert performance, investigating false positives, and refining detection logic.
- Built detection content for identity-based threats, cloud misconfigurations, and endpoint anomalies within Microsoft Sentinel, integrating Defender XDR signals for correlated, high-confidence alerts.
- Performed structured alert triage and security incident investigation across Sentinel SIEM and CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, managing incidents from detection through containment, eradication, and post-incident review.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) with Conditional Access policies, MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), and Privileged Identity Management to enforce zero-trust access controls.
- Managed vulnerability management operations using Tenable.io and Nessus, coordinating remediation with infrastructure teams based on exploitability, exposure, and business impact.
- Deployed BeyondTrust PAM, managing privileged session monitoring, credential vaulting, and least-privilege enforcement across critical systems.
- Automated repetitive security operations tasks via PowerShell scripting, including alert handling, user lifecycle management, and compliance reporting.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

- Configured and monitored SIEM alerting and endpoint security controls for the SaaS platform, triaging events and escalating confirmed security incidents.
- Supported vulnerability management and penetration testing activities using Nessus and third-party testers, tracking findings to remediation.
- Maintained ISO 27001 information security management policies and contributed to audit evidence collection and compliance reporting.
- Administered Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM for mobile device and application policy management across the organisation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built a comprehensive library of MITRE ATT&CK-mapped KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, covering 70%+ of relevant ATT&CK techniques within the first year of deployment.
- Reduced alert fatigue by 40% through systematic detection tuning, false positive analysis, and implementing detection-as-code practices in Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender XDR across 8,000 users, integrating Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and M365 Defender into a unified XDR detection and response workflow.
- Automated 60% of initial alert triage via SOAR playbooks in Azure Logic Apps, improving first response speed and consistency.
- Identified and contained a credential harvesting campaign through proactive threat hunting in Sentinel using KQL, preventing potential data exfiltration before automated alerts fired.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)